

ACompare **at**, **on** and **in**:

- ☐ They arrived **at 5 o'clock**.
- ☐ They arrived **on Friday**.
- ☐ They arrived **in June**. / They arrived **in 2012**.

We use:

at for the time of day**at five o'clock at 11.45 at midnight at lunchtime at sunset etc.****on** for days and dates**on Friday / on Fridays on 16 May 2012 on New Year's Day on my birthday****in** for longer periods (months/years/seasons etc.)**in June in 2012 in the 1990s in the 20th century in the past in winter****B**

We say:

at the moment / at the minute / at present / at this time (= now):

- ☐ Can we talk later? I'm busy **at the moment**.

at the same time

- ☐ Kate and I arrived **at the same time**.

at the weekends / at weekends (or **on the weekend / on weekends** in American English):

- ☐ Will you be here **at the weekend?** (or ... **on the weekend**)

at Christmas (but **on Christmas Day**)

- ☐ Do you give each other presents **at Christmas?**

at night (= during nights in general), **in the night** (= during a particular night):

- ☐ I don't like working **at night**. but I was woken up by a noise **in the night**.

C

We say:

in the morning(s)*but***in the afternoon(s)****in the evening(s)****on Friday morning(s)****on Sunday afternoon(s)****on Monday evening(s) etc.**

- ☐ I'll see you **in the morning**.
- ☐ Do you work **in the evenings?**

- ☐ I'll see you **on Friday morning**.
- ☐ Do you work **on Saturday evenings?**

DWe do not use **at/on/in** before **last/next/this/every**:

- ☐ I'll see you **next Friday**. (not on next Friday)
- ☐ They got married **last June**.

We often leave out **on** before days. So you can say:

- ☐ I'll see you **on Friday**. or I'll see you **Friday**.
- ☐ I don't work **on Monday mornings**. or I don't work **Monday mornings**.

EWe say that something will happen **in a few minutes / in six months** etc. :

- ☐ The train will be leaving **in a few minutes**. (= a few minutes from now)
- ☐ Andy has gone away. He'll be back **in a week**. (= a week from now)
- ☐ They'll be here **in a moment**. (= a moment from now, very soon)

We also use **in ...** to say how long it takes to do something:

- ☐ I learnt to drive **in four weeks**. (= it took me four weeks to learn)

Exercises

121.1 Put in **at**, **on** or **in**.

- 1 Mozart was born in Salzburg in 1756.
- 2 I've been invited to a wedding 14 February.
- 3 Amy's birthday is May, but I don't know which date.
- 4 This park is popular and gets very busy weekends.
- 5 I haven't seen Kate for a few days. I last saw her Tuesday.
- 6 Jonathan is 63. He'll be retiring from his job two years.
- 7 I'm busy right now. I'll be with you a moment.
- 8 Sam isn't here the moment, but he'll be here this afternoon.
- 9 There are usually a lot of parties New Year's Eve.
- 10 I don't like the dark. I try to avoid going out night.
- 11 It rained very hard the night. Did you hear it?
- 12 My car is being repaired at the garage. It will be ready two hours.
- 13 The bus station was busy. A lot of buses were leaving the same time.
- 14 Helen and David always go out for dinner their wedding anniversary.
- 15 It was a short book and easy to read. I read it a day.
- 16 midday, the sun is at its highest point in the sky.
- 17 This building is very old. It was built the fifteenth century.
- 18 The office is closed Wednesday afternoons.
- 19 In the UK many people go home to see their families Christmas.
- 20 My flight arrives 5 o'clock the morning.
- 21 The course begins 7 January and ends sometime April.
- 22 I might not be at home Tuesday morning, but I'll be there the afternoon.

121.2 Complete the sentences. Use **at**, **on** or **in** + the following:

the evening	about 20 minutes	1756	the same time	the 1920s
the moment	21 July 1969	night	Saturdays	11 seconds

- 1 Mozart was born in 1756
- 2 If the sky is clear, you can see the stars
- 3 After working hard during the day, I like to relax
- 4 Neil Armstrong was the first man to walk on the moon
- 5 It's difficult to listen if everyone is speaking
- 6 Jazz became popular in the United States
- 7 I'm just going out to the shop. I'll be back
- 8 I don't think we need an umbrella. It's not raining
- 9 Ben is a very fast runner. He can run 100 metres
- 10 Lisa works from Monday to Friday. Sometimes she also works

121.3 Which is correct: **a**, **b**, or **both** of them?

- | | | |
|--|--------------------------------------|-------------|
| 1 a I'll see you on Friday. | b I'll see you Friday. | <u>both</u> |
| 2 a I'll see you on next Friday. | b I'll see you next Friday. | <u>b</u> |
| 3 a Paul got married in April. | b Paul got married April. | |
| 4 a I play tennis on Sunday mornings. | b I play tennis Sunday mornings. | |
| 5 a We were ill at the same time. | b We were ill in the same time. | |
| 6 a What are you doing at the weekend? | b What are you doing on the weekend? | |
| 7 a Oliver was born at 10 May 1993. | b Oliver was born on 10 May 1993. | |
| 8 a He left school last June. | b He left school in last June. | |
| 9 a Will you be here on Tuesday? | b Will you be here Tuesday? | |
| 10 a I don't like driving in night. | b I don't like driving at night. | |

A on time and in time

on time = punctual, not late

If something happens **on time**, it happens at the time that was planned:

- ☐ The 11.45 train left **on time**. (= it left at 11.45)
- ☐ Please be **on time**. Don't be late.
- ☐ The conference was well-organised. Everything began and finished **on time**.

in time (for something / to do something) = soon enough

- ☐ Will you be home **in time for dinner**? (= soon enough for dinner)
- ☐ I sent Amy a birthday present. I hope it arrives **in time**.
(= on or before her birthday)
- ☐ I'm in a hurry. I want to get home **in time to watch** the game on TV.
(= soon enough to see the game)

The opposite of **in time** is **too late**:

- ☐ I got home **too late** to watch the game on TV.

You can say **just in time** (= almost too late):

- ☐ We got to the station **just in time** for our train.
- ☐ A child ran into the road in front of the car, but I managed to stop **just in time**.

B at the end and in the end

at the end (of something) = at the time when something ends

For example:

- | | | |
|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| at the end of the month | at the end of January | at the end of the game |
| at the end of the film | at the end of the course | at the end of the concert |
- ☐ I'm going away **at the end of January / at the end of the month**.
 - ☐ **At the end of the concert**, everyone applauded.
 - ☐ The players shook hands **at the end of the game**.

We do not say 'in the end of ...'. For example, we do not say 'in the end of January'.

The opposite of **at the end** is **at the beginning**:

- ☐ I'm going away **at the beginning of January**. (*not* in the beginning)

in the end = finally

We use **in the end** when we say what the final result of a situation was:

- ☐ We had a lot of problems with our car. We sold it **in the end**. (= finally we sold it)
- ☐ He got more and more angry. **In the end** he just walked out of the room.
- ☐ Alan couldn't decide where to go for his holidays. He didn't go anywhere **in the end**.
(*not* at the end)

The opposite of **in the end** is **at first**:

- ☐ **At first** we didn't get on very well, but **in the end** we became good friends.

Exercises

122.1 Complete the sentences with **on time** or **in time**.

- The bus is usually on time, but it was late this morning.
- The film was supposed to start at 8.30, but it didn't begin
- The train service isn't very good. The trains are rarely
- We nearly missed our train. We got to the station just
- We want to start the meeting, so please don't be late.
- I've just washed this shirt. I want to wear it this evening, so I hope it will be dry
- I almost forgot that it was Joe's birthday. Fortunately I remembered
- Why are you never? You always keep everybody waiting.
- It is hoped that the new stadium will be ready for the tournament later this year.

122.2 Read the situations and make sentences using **just in time**.

- A child ran into the road in front of your car. You saw the child at the last moment.
(manage / stop) I managed to stop just in time.
- You were walking home. Just after you got home, it started to rain very heavily.
(get / home) I
- Your friend was going to sit on the chair you had just painted. You said, 'Don't sit on that chair!', so he didn't. (stop / him) I
- You and a friend went to the cinema. You were late, and you thought you would miss the beginning of the film. But the film began just as you sat down in the cinema.
(get / cinema / beginning / film)
We

122.3 Complete the sentences using **at the end** + the following:

the course ~~the game~~ the interview the month the race

- The players shook hands at the end of the game
- I get paid
- The students had a party
- Two of the runners collapsed
- I was surprised when I was offered the job

122.4 Write sentences with **in the end**. Use the verb in brackets.

- We had a lot of problems with our car. (sell) In the end we sold it.
- Anna got more and more fed up with her job.
(resign)
- I tried to learn Japanese, but I found it too difficult.
(give up)
- We couldn't decide whether to go to the party or not.
(not / go)

122.5 Put in **at** or **in**.

- I'm going away at the end of the month.
- It took Gary a long time to find work. the end he got a job as a bus driver.
- I couldn't decide what to buy Amy for her birthday. I didn't buy her anything the end.
- I'm going away the end of this week.
- We waited ages for a bus. the end we had to get a taxi.
- the end of the lesson, all the students left the classroom.
- We had a few problems at first, but the end everything was OK.
- You were in a difficult position. What did you do the end?
- The journey took a very long time, but we got there the end.
- Are you going away the beginning of August or the end?

A in



in a room
in a building
in a box
etc.



in a garden
in a town
in the city centre
etc.



in a pool
in the sea
in a river
etc.

- ☐ There's no-one **in the room** / **in the building** / **in the garden**.
- ☐ What do you have **in your hand** / **in your mouth**?
- ☐ When we were **in Italy**, we spent a few days **in Venice**.
- ☐ I have a friend who lives **in a small village in the mountains**.
- ☐ There were some people swimming **in the pool** / **in the sea** / **in the river**.

B at



at the bus stop



at the door



at the roundabout



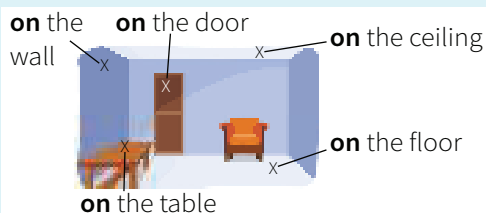
at her desk

- ☐ Who is that man standing **at the bus stop** / **at the door** / **at the window**?
- ☐ Turn left **at the traffic lights** / **at the next junction** / **at the roundabout** / **at the church**.
- ☐ We have to get off the bus **at the next stop**.
- ☐ When you leave the hotel, please leave your key **at reception**. (= at the reception desk)

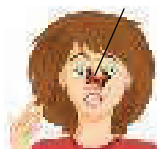
Compare **in** and **at**:

- ☐ There were a lot of people **in the shop**. It was crowded.
Go along this road, then turn left **at the shop**.
- ☐ I'll meet you **in the hotel lobby**. (= in the building)
I'll meet you **at the entrance to the hotel**. (= outside the building)

C on



on her nose



on a page



on an island

- ☐ I sat **on the floor** / **on the ground** / **on the grass** / **on the beach** / **on a chair**.
- ☐ There's a dirty mark **on the ceiling** / **on your nose** / **on your shirt**.
- ☐ Did you see the notice **on the wall** / **on the door**?
- ☐ You'll find details of TV programmes **on page seven** of the newspaper.
- ☐ The hotel is **on a small island** in the middle of a lake.

Compare **in** and **on**:

- ☐ There is some water **in the bottle**.
There is a label **on the bottle**.

Compare **at** and **on**:

- ☐ There is somebody **at the door**. Shall I go and see who it is?
There is a notice **on the door**. It says 'Do not disturb'.



Exercises

123.1 Answer the questions about the pictures. Use **in**, **at** or **on** with the words below the pictures.



- 1 Where's the label? On the bottle.
- 2 Where's the fly?
- 3 Where's the car waiting?
- 4 Where's the notice? Where's the key?
- 5 Where are the shelves?
- 6 Where's the Eiffel Tower?
- 7 Where's the man standing? Where's the bird?
- 8 Where are the children playing?

123.2 Complete the sentences. Use **in**, **at** or **on** + the following:

the window **his hand** **the mountains** **that tree**
my guitar **the river** **the island** **junction 14**

- 1 There were some people swimming in the river.
- 2 One of the strings is broken.
- 3 Leave the motorway and then turn left.
- 4 He was holding something, but I couldn't see what it was.
- 5 The leaves are a beautiful colour.
- 6 You can go skiing near here. There's plenty of snow.
- 7 There's nobody living It's uninhabited.
- 8 He spends most of the day sitting and looking outside.

123.3 Complete the sentences with **in**, **at** or **on**.

- 1 There was a long queue of people at the bus stop.
- 2 Nicola was wearing a silver ring her little finger.
- 3 There was a security guard standing the entrance to the building.
- 4 I wasn't sure whether I had come to the right office. There was no name the door.
- 5 There are plenty of shops and restaurants the town centre.
- 6 You'll find the weather forecast the back page of the newspaper.
- 7 The headquarters of the company are California.
- 8 I wouldn't like an office job. I couldn't spend the whole day sitting a desk.
- 9 The man the police are looking for has a scar his right cheek.
- 10 If you come here by bus, get off the stop after the traffic lights.
- 11 Have you ever been camping? Have you ever slept a tent?
- 12 Emily was sitting the balcony reading a book.
- 13 My brother lives a small village the south-west of England.
- 14 I like that picture hanging the wall the kitchen.

A We say that somebody/something is:

in a line, in a row, in a queue
in a picture, in a photo(graph)
in a newspaper, in a magazine, in a book

in an office, in a department
in the sky, in the world
in the country (= not in a town)

- ☐ When I go to the cinema, I like to sit **in the front row**.
- ☐ Amy works **in the sales department**.
- ☐ Who is the woman **in that picture**?
- ☐ Do you live in a city or **in the country**?
- ☐ It's a lovely day. There isn't a cloud **in the sky**.



They're standing **in a row**.

B We say that somebody/something is:

on the left, on the right (or **on the left-hand side, on the right-hand side**)

- ☐ Do you drive **on the left** or **on the right** in your country?

on the ground floor, on the first floor, on the second floor etc.

- ☐ Our apartment is **on the second floor** of the building.

on a map, on a menu, on a list, on a page, on a website

- ☐ Here's the shopping list. Don't buy anything that's not **on the list**.
- ☐ You'll find the information you need **on our website**.

We say that a place is **on a river / on a road / on the coast**:

- ☐ Vienna is **on the** (river) **Danube**.
- ☐ The town where you live – is it **on the coast** or is it inland?

We say **on the way** (from one place to another):

- ☐ We stopped at a shop **on the way** home.



C We say:

at the top (of ...), **at the bottom** (of ...), **at the end** (of ...)

- ☐ Write your name **at the top of the page**.
- ☐ Jane lives **at the other end of the street**.

at the top (of the page)

at the bottom (of the page)



D We say:

in the front, in the back of a car

- ☐ I was **in the back** (of the car) when we had the accident.

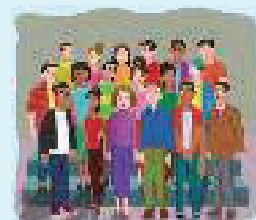
at the front, at the back of a building / theatre / group of people etc.

- ☐ The garden is **at the back of the house**.
- ☐ Let's sit **at the front** (of the cinema).
- ☐ We were **at the back**, so we couldn't see very well.

on the front, on the back of an envelope / a piece of paper etc.

- ☐ I wrote the date **on the back of the photo**.

at the back



at the front

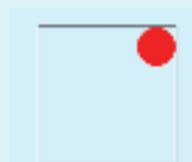
E We say:

in the corner of a room

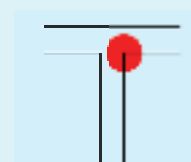
- ☐ The TV is **in the corner** of the room.

at the corner or **on the corner** of a street

- ☐ There is a small shop **at the corner** (of the street).
or ... **on the corner** (of the street).



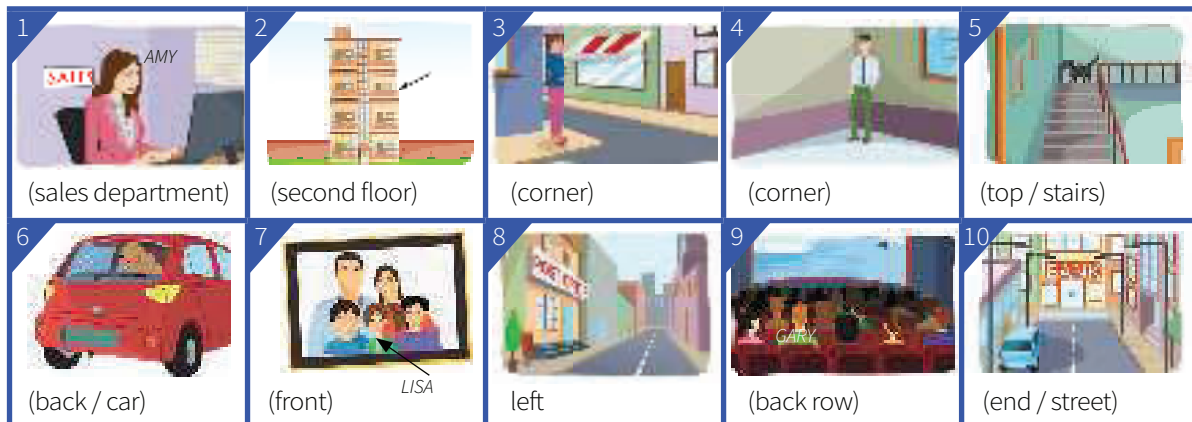
in the corner



at or on the corner

Exercises

124.1 Answer the questions about the pictures. Use **in**, **at** or **on** with the words below the pictures.



- 1 Where does Amy work? In the sales department.
- 2 Amy lives in this building. Where's her flat exactly?
- 3 Where is the woman standing?
- 4 Where is the man standing?
- 5 Where's the cat?
- 6 Where's the dog?
- 7 Lisa is in this group of people. Where is she?
- 8 Where's the post office?
- 9 Gary is at the cinema. Where is he sitting?
- 10 Where is the bank?

124.2 Complete the sentences. Use **in**, **at** or **on** + the following:

the west coast
the front row

the world
the right

the back of the class
the back of this card

the sky
the way to work

- 1 It's a lovely day. There isn't a cloud in the sky.
- 2 In most countries people drive
- 3 What is the tallest building?
- 4 I met a friend of mine this morning.
- 5 San Francisco is of the United States.
- 6 We went to the theatre last night. We had seats
- 7 I couldn't hear the teacher. She spoke quietly and I was sitting
- 8 I don't have your address. Could you write it?

124.3 Complete the sentences with **in**, **at** or **on**.

- 1 Write your name at the top of the page.
- 2 Is your sister this photo? I don't recognise her.
- 3 They live in a small house the bottom of the hill.
- 4 We normally use the front entrance to the building, but there's another one the back.
- 5 We had to wait a queue for an hour to check in at the airport.
- 6 There was a list of names, but my name wasn't the list.
- 7 Is there anything interesting today's newspaper?
- 8 I love to look up at the stars the sky at night.
- 9 When I'm a passenger in a car, I prefer to sit the front.
- 10 I live in a very small village. You probably won't find it your map.
- 11 Joe works the furniture department of a large store.
- 12 Paris is the (river) Seine.
- 13 I don't like cities. I'd much prefer to live the country.
- 14 My office is the top floor. It's your left as you come out of the lift.

A in hospital / at work etc.

We say that somebody is **in bed** / **in hospital** / **in prison**:

- ☐ James isn't up yet. He's still **in bed**.
- ☐ Anna's mother is **in hospital**.

We say that somebody is **at home** / **at work** / **at school** / **at university** / **at college**:

- ☐ I'll be **at work** until 5.30.
- ☐ My sister is **at university**. My brother is still **at school**.

We say **be at home** or **be home** (with or without **at**), but **do something at home** (with **at**):

- ☐ I'll **be home** all evening. *or* I'll **be at home** all evening.
- ☐ Shall we go to a restaurant or **eat at home**?

B at a party / at a concert etc.

We say that somebody is **at** an event (**at a party**, **at a conference** etc.):

- ☐ Were there many people **at the party** / **at the meeting** / **at the wedding**?
- ☐ I saw Steve **at a conference** / **at a concert** on Saturday.

C in and at for buildings

You can often use **in** or **at** with buildings. For example, you can eat **in a restaurant** or **at a restaurant**; you can buy food **in a supermarket** or **at a supermarket**.

We usually say **at** when we say where an event takes place (a concert, a party, a meeting etc.):

- ☐ We went to a concert **at the National Concert Hall**.
- ☐ The meeting took place **at the company's head office** in Frankfurt.
- ☐ There was a robbery **at the supermarket**.

We say **at** somebody's house:

- ☐ I was **at Helen's house** last night. *or* I was **at Helen's** last night.

In the same way we say **at the doctor's**, **at the hairdresser's** etc.

We use **in** when we are thinking about the building itself. Compare **at** and **in**:

- ☐ I was **at Helen's** (house) last night.
- ☐ It's always cold **in Helen's house**. The heating doesn't work well. (*not* at Helen's house)
- ☐ We had dinner **at the hotel**.
- ☐ All the rooms **in the hotel** have air conditioning. (*not* at the hotel)

We say **at the station** / **at the airport**:

- ☐ There's no need to meet me **at the station**. I can get a taxi.

D in and at for towns etc.

We normally use **in** with cities, towns and villages:

- ☐ The Louvre is a famous art museum **in Paris**. (*not* at Paris)
- ☐ Sam's parents live **in a village** in the south of France. (*not* at a village)

We use **at** when we think of the place as a point or station on a journey:

- ☐ Does this train stop **at Oxford**? (= at Oxford station)

E on a bus / in a car etc.

We usually say **on a bus** / **on a train** / **on a plane** / **on a ship** *but* **in a car** / **in a taxi**:

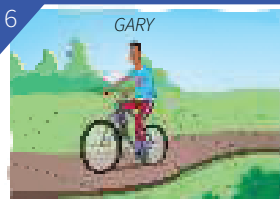
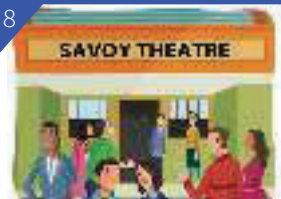
- ☐ **The bus** was very full. There were too many people **on it**.
- ☐ Laura arrived **in a taxi**.

We say **on a bike** (= bicycle) / **on a motorbike** / **on a horse**:

- ☐ Jane passed me **on her bike**.

Exercises

125.1 Complete the sentences about the pictures. Use **in**, **at** or **on** with the words below the pictures.

1  (the airport)	2  (a train) DAVE	3  (a conference) KAREN	4  (hospital) MARTIN
5  (the hairdresser's) JUDY	6  (his bike) GARY	7  (New York)	8  (the Savoy Theatre)

- | | |
|--|-----------------------------|
| 1 You can hire a car <u>at the airport</u> . | 5 Judy is |
| 2 Dave is | 6 I saw Gary |
| 3 Karen is | 7 We spent a few days |
| 4 Martin | 8 We went to a show |

125.2 Complete the sentences. Use **in**, **at** or **on** + the following:

the plane Tokyo	the station school	a taxi prison	the art gallery the sports centre
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- Some people are in prison for crimes that they did not commit.
- We can get coffee while we're waiting for our train.
- We walked to the restaurant, but we went home
- I play basketball on Friday evenings.
- I enjoyed the flight, but the food was awful.
- Vicky has gone to Japan. She's living
- 'Does your sister have a job?' 'No, she's only 16. She's still'
- There's a new exhibition of paintings Let's go and see it.

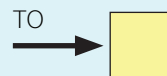
125.3 Complete these sentences with **in**, **at** or **on**.

- We went to a concert at the National Concert Hall.
- There isn't a shop the village where I live. It's very small.
- Joe wasn't the party. I don't know why he didn't go.
- There were about ten tables the restaurant, and four tables outside.
- I don't know where my umbrella is. Perhaps I left it the bus.
- What do you want to study university?
- I didn't feel well when I woke up, so I stayed bed.
- We were Sarah's house last night. She invited us to dinner.
- It was a very slow train. It stopped every station.
- Shall we travel your car or mine?
- We took a taxi and Ben followed his motorbike.
- I'd like to see a movie. What's on the cinema this week?
- We went to see a movie last night. It was really cold the cinema.
- Two people were injured in the accident and are still hospital.
- Our flight was delayed. We had to wait the airport for three hours.
- I didn't expect you to be home. I thought you'd be work.

A

We say **go/come/travel** (etc.) **to** a place or event. For example:

go to China	go to work	come to my house
go back to Italy	go to the bank	drive to the airport
return to London	go to a party	be taken to hospital



- ☐ When are your friends **going back to Italy**? (*not* going back in Italy)
- ☐ Three people were injured in the accident and **taken to hospital**.

In the same way we say **Welcome to** ..., a **trip to** ..., a **visit to** ..., on **my way to** ... etc. :

- ☐ **Welcome to our country!** (*not* Welcome in)
- ☐ We had to cancel **our trip to Paris**.

Compare **to** (for *movement*) and **in/at** (for *position*):

- ☐ They are **going to** France. *but* They **live in** France.
- ☐ Can you **come to** the party? *but* I'll **see you at** the party.

We say '(I've) **been to**' a place or an event:

- ☐ I've **been to Italy** four times, but I've never **been to Rome**.
- ☐ Amanda has never **been to a football match** in her life.

B

get and arrive

We say **get to** a place:

- ☐ They **got to the hotel** at midnight.
- ☐ What time did you **get to the party**?

We say **arrive in** ... or **arrive at** ... (*not* arrive to).

We say **arrive in** a town or country:

- ☐ They **arrived in Madrid / in Spain** a week ago.

For other places (buildings etc.) or events, we say **arrive at**:

- ☐ What time did you **arrive at the hotel / at the airport / at the party**?

C

home

We say: **go home, come home, get home, arrive home, on the way home** etc. (no preposition).

We do not say 'to home':

- ☐ What time did you **get home**? (*not* get to home)
- ☐ I met Lisa **on my way home**.

D

into

go into, get into ... etc. = enter (a room / a building / a car etc.):

- ☐ I opened the door, **went into the room** and sat down.
- ☐ A bird **flew into the kitchen** through the window.
- ☐ Every month my salary **is paid directly into my bank account**.



With some verbs (especially **go/get/put**) we often use **in** (instead of **into**):

- ☐ She **got in the car** and drove away. *or* She **got into** the car ...
- ☐ I read the letter and **put it back in the envelope**.

The opposite of **into** is **out of**:

- ☐ She **got out of** the car and **went into** a shop.

For buses, trains and planes, we usually say **get on** and **get off**:

- ☐ She **got on the bus** and I never saw her again.
- ☐ You need to **get off** (the train) at the next station.

Exercises

126.1 Put in **to/at/in/into** where necessary. If no preposition is necessary, leave the space empty.

- 1 Three people were taken to hospital after the accident.
- 2 I'm tired. Let's go - home now. (*no preposition*)
- 3 We left our luggage the station and went to find something to eat.
- 4 Shall we take a taxi the station or shall we walk?
- 5 I have to go the bank today. What time does it open?
- 6 The Amazon flows the Atlantic Ocean.
- 7 I missed the bus, so I walked home.
- 8 Have you ever been Canada?
- 9 I lost my key, but I managed to climb the house through a window.
- 10 We got stuck in a traffic jam on our way the airport.
- 11 We had lunch the airport while we were waiting for our plane.
- 12 It took us four hours to get the top of the mountain.
- 13 Welcome the hotel. We hope you enjoy your stay here.
- 14 We drove along the main road and then turned a narrow side street.
- 15 Did you enjoy your visit the zoo?
- 16 I did some shopping on my way home.
- 17 Marcel is French. He has just returned France after two years Brazil.
- 18 Carl was born Chicago, but his family moved Boston when he was three.

126.2 Write sentences about places you have been to. Use **I've been to / I've never been to + the words in brackets**.

- 1 (never) I've never been to Egypt.
- 2 (once)
- 3 (never)
- 4 (a few times)
- 5 (many times)

126.3 Put in **to/at/in** where necessary. If no preposition is necessary, leave the space empty.

- 1 What time does this train get to London?
- 2 They arrived Barcelona a few days ago.
- 3 What time did you get home last night?
- 4 What time do you usually arrive work in the morning?
- 5 When we got the cinema, there was a long queue outside.
- 6 We were delayed and arrived home very late.

126.4 Write sentences using **got + into / out of / on / off**.

- 1 You were walking home. A friend passed you in her car. She saw you, stopped and offered you a lift. She opened the door. What did you do? I got into the car.
- 2 You were waiting at the bus stop. At last your bus came and stopped. The doors opened. What did you do then? I the bus.
- 3 You drove home in your car. You stopped outside your house and parked the car. What did you do then?
- 4 You were travelling by train to Manchester. When the train got to Manchester, what did you do?
- 5 You needed a taxi. After a few minutes a taxi stopped for you. You opened the door. What did you do then?
- 6 You were travelling by plane. At the end of your flight, your plane landed at the airport and stopped. The doors were opened, you took your bag and stood up. What did you do then?

in/on/at (other uses)

A in

in the rain / in the sun / in the shade / in the dark / in bad weather etc.

- ☐ We sat **in the shade**. It was too hot to sit **in the sun**.
- ☐ Don't go out **in the rain**. Wait until it stops.

in a language / **in** a currency etc.

- ☐ How do you say 'thank you' **in Russian**?
- ☐ How much is a hundred pounds **in dollars**?

(be/fall) **in love** (with somebody)

- ☐ They're very happy together. They're **in love**.

in a (good/bad) **mood**

- ☐ You seem to be **in a bad mood**. What's the matter?

in (my) **opinion**

- ☐ **In my opinion** the movie wasn't very good.



in the shade

B on

on TV / on television

on the radio

on the phone

on fire

on purpose (= intentionally)

on the whole (= in general)

- ☐ I didn't see the news **on TV**.
- ☐ I heard the weather forecast **on the radio**.
- ☐ I've never met her, but I've spoken to her **on the phone**.
- ☐ Look! That car is **on fire**.
- ☐ I'm sorry. I didn't mean to hurt you. I didn't do it **on purpose**.
- ☐ Sometimes I have problems at work, but **on the whole** I enjoy my job.

C

on holiday / on a trip etc.

(be/go) **on holiday / on vacation**

(be/go) **on a trip / on a tour / on a cruise** etc.

(be/go to a place) **on business**

(be/go) **on strike**

(be/go) **on a diet**

- ☐ I'm going **on holiday** next week.
- ☐ One day I'd like to go **on a world tour**.
- ☐ Emma's away **on business** at the moment.
- ☐ There are no trains today. The drivers are **on strike**.
- ☐ I've put on weight. I'll have to go **on a diet**.

We also say 'go somewhere **for a holiday**':

- ☐ Steve has gone to France **for a holiday**.

D

at the age of ... etc.

at the age of 16 / at 90 miles an hour / at 100 degrees etc. :

- ☐ Tracy left school **at 16**. or
Tracy left school **at the age of 16**.
- ☐ The train was travelling **at 120 miles an hour**.
- ☐ Water boils **at 100 degrees Celsius**.

We are now flying **at a speed of** 800 kilometres an hour and **at an altitude of** 9,000 metres.



Exercises

127.1 Complete the sentences using **in** + the following:

the mood	cold weather	love	my opinion
French	the rain	kilometres	the shade

- Don't go out in the rain. Wait until it stops.
- Matt likes to keep warm, so he doesn't go out much
- The movie was with English subtitles.
- They fell almost immediately and were married in a few weeks.
- I don't feel like going to a party tonight. I'm not
- It's too hot here. I'm going to sit under that tree.
- Amanda thought the restaurant was OK, but it wasn't very good.
- Fifty miles? What's that ?

127.2 Complete the sentences using **on** + the following:

business	a cruise	a diet	fire	holiday	her phone
the radio	purpose	strike	TV	a tour	the whole

- I heard the weather forecast on the radio. It's going to get warmer.
- Workers at the company have gone for better pay and conditions.
- Don't go if you don't like being at sea.
- There was panic when people realised that the building was
- Soon after we arrived, we were taken of the city.
- Emma has lots of useful apps
- I feel lazy this evening. Is there anything worth watching ?
- I'm sorry. It was an accident. I didn't do it
- If you are, there are certain things you're not allowed to eat.
- We'll be from Friday. We're going to the mountains.
- Jane's job involves a lot of travelling. She often has to go away
- Some of the exam questions were hard, but it was OK.

127.3 Complete the sentences with **in**, **on** or **at**.

- Water boils at 100 degrees Celsius.
- When I was 14, I went a trip to France organised by my school.
- Julia's grandmother died recently the age of 90.
- Can you turn the light on, please? I don't want to sit the dark.
- We didn't go holiday last year. We stayed at home.
- I hate driving fog. You can't see anything.
- Technology has developed great speed.
- David got married 19, which is rather young to get married.
- I listened to an interesting programme the radio this morning.
- I wouldn't like to go a cruise. I think I'd get bored.
- The earth travels round the sun 107,000 kilometres an hour.
- I shouldn't eat too much. I'm supposed to be a diet.
- A lot of houses were damaged the storm last week.
- I won't be here next week. I'll be holiday.
- I wouldn't like his job. He spends most of his time talking the phone.
- 'Did you enjoy your holiday?' 'Not every minute, but the whole, yes.'
- your opinion, what should I do?
- Ben is a happy sort of person. He always seems to be a good mood.
- I don't think violent films should be shown TV.
- The museum guidebook is available several languages.

A

You can say that something happens **by mistake** / **by accident** / **by chance**:

- ☐ We hadn't arranged to meet. We met **by chance**.

But we say 'do something **on purpose**' (= you mean to do it):

- ☐ I didn't do it **on purpose**. It was an accident.

Note that we say **by chance**, **by accident** etc. (*not* by the chance / by an accident).

In these expressions we use **by** + *noun* without **the** or **a**.

B

We use **by** ... to say how somebody travels. For example, you can travel:

by car **by train** **by plane** **by boat** **by ship** **by bus** **by bike** etc.

- ☐ Jess usually goes to work **by bus** / **by bike** / **by car**.

We do not use **by** if we say **my car** / **the train** / **a taxi** etc. We say:

by car *but* **in my car** (*not* by my car)

by train *but* **on the train** (*not* by the train)

We use **in** for cars and taxis:

- ☐ They didn't come **in their car**. They came **in a taxi**.

We use **on** for bikes and public transport (buses, trains etc.):

- ☐ We travelled **on the 6.45 train**, which arrived at 8.30.

Note that we usually say **on foot** (*not usually* by foot):

- ☐ Did you come here **by car** or **on foot**?

We also use **by** to say how we do other things. For example, you can:

send something **by post** pay **by card** / **by cheque** do something **by hand**

- ☐ Can I pay **by credit card**?

But note that we say **pay cash** or **pay in cash** (*not usually* by cash).

C

We say that 'something is done **by** ...' (*passive*):

- ☐ Have you ever been bitten **by a dog**?
- ☐ The programme was watched **by millions of people**.

Compare **by** and **with**:

- ☐ The door must have been opened **with a key**. (*not* by a key)
(= somebody used a key to open it)
- ☐ The door must have been opened **by somebody** with a key.

We say: a play **by Shakespeare**, a painting **by Rembrandt**, a novel **by Tolstoy** etc.

- ☐ Have you read any poems **by Shakespeare**?
- ☐ 'Who is this painting **by**? Picasso?' 'I have no idea.'

D

By also means 'next to / beside':

- ☐ The light switch is **by the door**.
- ☐ Come and sit **by me**. (= next to me)

LIGHT SWITCH →



E

You can also use **by** ... to show the difference between two things:

- ☐ Clare's salary has increased **by ten per cent**.
(= it's now ten per cent more than before)
- ☐ Carl won the race **by five metres**.
(= he was five metres in front of the other runners)



Exercises

128.1 Complete the sentences. Choose from the box.

- 1 We don't need cash. We can pay by credit card.
- 2 Kate and James keep in touch with one another mainly
- 3 I didn't intend to take your umbrella. I took it
- 4 I think he arrived late He wanted to keep us waiting.
- 5 Some things are planned. Other things happen
- 6 Don't put my sweater in the washing machine. It has to be washed

by mistake
by hand
~~by credit card~~
by chance
by email
on purpose

128.2 Put in **by**, **in** or **on**.

- 1 Jess usually goes to work by bus.
- 2 I saw Jane this morning. She was the bus.
- 3 How did you get here? Did you come train?
- 4 I couldn't find a seat the train. It was full.
- 5 How much will it cost to the airport taxi?
- 6 Did you come here Sarah's car or yours?
- 7 The injured man was taken to hospital ambulance.
- 8 How long does it take to cross the Atlantic ship?
- 9 He doesn't drive much. He goes everywhere bike or foot.

128.3 Complete these sentences about books, paintings etc. Choose from the box.

- 1 I was woken up in the night by a strange noise.
- 2 These pictures were taken
- 3 I hate getting bitten
- 4 'Mona Lisa' is a famous painting
- 5 We lost the game because of a mistake
- 6 The plane was damaged, but landed safely.
- 7 This music is, but I can't remember what it's called.

by mosquitoes
by one of our players
by lightning
by Beethoven
~~by a strange noise~~
by Leonardo da Vinci
by a professional
photographer

128.4 Put in **by**, **in**, **on** or **with**.

- 1 Have you ever been bitten by a dog?
- 2 We managed to put the fire out a fire extinguisher.
- 3 Who's that man standing the window?
- 4 Do you travel much bus?
- 5 We travelled my friend's car because it is larger and more comfortable than mine.
- 6 It was only accident that I discovered the error.
- 7 These pictures were taken a very good camera.
- 8 My friends live in a beautiful house the sea.
- 9 There were only a few people the plane. It was almost empty.
- 10 The new railway line will reduce the journey time two hours (from five hours to three).
- 11 There was a small table the bed a lamp and a clock it.

128.5 Complete the sentences using **by**.

- 1 Carl won the race. He was five metres in front of the other runners.
Carl won by five metres.
- 2 Ten years ago the population of the country was 50 million. Now it is 56 million.
In the last ten years the population has
- 3 There was an election. Helen won. She got 25 votes and James got 23.
Helen won
- 4 I went to Kate's office to see her, but she had left work five minutes before I arrived.
I missed

Noun + preposition (**reason for, cause of** etc.)**A** noun + **for** ...a **demand** / a **need FOR** ...

- ☐ The company went out of business. There was no **demand for** its product any more.
- ☐ There's no excuse for behaviour like that. There's no **need for** it.

a **reason FOR** ...

- ☐ The train was late, but nobody knew the **reason for** the delay. (*not* reason of)

B noun + **of** ...a **cause OF** ...

- ☐ The **cause of** the explosion is unknown.

a **picture** / a **photo** / a **photograph** / a **map** / a **plan** / a **drawing** (etc.) **OF** ...

- ☐ Rachel showed me some **pictures of** her family.
- ☐ I had a **map of** the town, so I was able to find my way around.

an **advantage** / a **disadvantage OF** ...

- ☐ The **advantage of living alone** is that you can do what you like.

*but***there is** an advantage **IN** doing something *or* **TO** doing something:

- ☐ **There are** many advantages **in** living alone. *or* ... many advantages **to** living alone.

C noun + **in** ...an **increase** / a **decrease** / a **rise** / a **fall IN** (prices etc.)

- ☐ There has been an **increase in** the number of road accidents recently.
- ☐ Last year was a bad one for the company. There was a big **fall in** sales.

D noun + **to** ...**damage TO** ...

- ☐ The accident was my fault, so I had to pay for the **damage to** the other car.

an **invitation TO** ... (a party / a wedding etc.)

- ☐ Did you get an **invitation to** the wedding?

a **solution TO** a problem / a **key TO** a door / an **answer TO** a question / a **reply TO** a letter / a **reaction TO** something

- ☐ I hope we find a **solution to** the problem. (*not* a solution of the problem)
- ☐ I was surprised at her **reaction to** my suggestion.

an **attitude TO** ... *or* an **attitude TOWARDS** ...

- ☐ His **attitude to** his job is very negative. *or* His **attitude towards** his job ...

E noun + **with** ... / **between** ...a **relationship** / a **connection** / **contact WITH** ...

- ☐ Do you have a good **relationship with** your parents?
- ☐ The police want to question a man in **connection with** the robbery.

a **relationship** / a **connection** / **contact** / a **difference BETWEEN** two things or people

- ☐ The police believe that there is no **connection between** the two crimes.
- ☐ There are some **differences between** British and American English.

Exercises

129.1 Complete the second sentence so that it has the same meaning as the first.

- 1 What caused the explosion?
What was the cause of the explosion.....?
- 2 We're trying to solve the problem.
We're trying to find a solution
- 3 Sue gets on well with her brother.
Sue has a good relationship
- 4 The cost of living has gone up a lot.
There has been a big increase
- 5 I don't know how to answer your question.
I can't think of an answer
- 6 I don't think that a new road is necessary.
I don't think there is any need
- 7 I think that living in a big city has many advantages.
I think that there are many advantages
- 8 Food prices fell last month.
Last month there was a fall
- 9 Nobody wants shoes like these any more.
There is no demand
- 10 In what way is your job different from mine?
What is the difference

129.2 Complete the sentences using these nouns + a preposition:

cause key	connection map	contact photos	damage reason	invitation reply
--------------	------------------------------	-------------------	------------------	---------------------

- 1 On the classroom wall there were some pictures and a map of the world.
- 2 Thank you for the your birthday party.
- 3 Anna has little her family these days. She rarely sees them.
- 4 I can't open this door. Do you have a the other door?
- 5 The the fire at the hotel is still unknown.
- 6 Did you get a the email you sent?
- 7 The two companies are separate. There is no them.
- 8 Jane showed me some the city as it looked 100 years ago.
- 9 Emily has decided to give up her job. I don't know her doing this.
- 10 It wasn't a bad accident. The the car wasn't serious.

129.3 Complete the sentences with the correct preposition.

- 1 There are some differences between British and American English.
- 2 Money isn't the solution every problem.
- 3 There has been an increase the amount of traffic using this road.
- 4 The advantage having a car is that you don't have to rely on public transport.
- 5 There are many advantages being able to speak a foreign language.
- 6 Everything can be explained. There's a reason everything.
- 7 When Paul left home, his attitude many things seemed to change.
- 8 Ben and I used to be good friends, but I don't have much contact him now.
- 9 James did a very good drawing his father. It looks just like him.
- 10 What was Sarah's reaction the news?
- 11 Nicola took a picture me holding the baby.
- 12 The show is very popular and there has been a great demand tickets.
- 13 There has been a lot of debate about the causes climate change.
- 14 The fact that Jane was offered a job in the company has no connection the fact that she is a friend of the managing director.

Adjective + preposition 1

A nice of you, nice to me

nice / kind / good / generous / polite / honest / stupid / silly etc. **OF** somebody (to do something)

- It was **stupid of** me to go out without a coat in such cold weather.

(be) **nice / kind / good / generous / polite / rude / friendly / cruel** etc. **TO** somebody

- ☐ They have always been very **nice to** me. (*not with me*)
- ☐ Why were you so **unfriendly to** Lucy?

B *adjective* + **about** / **with**

angry / annoyed / furious / upset { ABOUT something
WITH somebody FOR doing something

- ☐ There's no point in getting **angry about** things that don't matter.
- ☐ Are you **annoyed with** me **for** being late?
- ☐ Lisa is **upset about** not being invited to the party.

excited / worried / nervous / happy etc. **ABOUT** something

- ☐ Are you **nervous about** the exam?

pleased / satisfied / happy / delighted / disappointed WITH something you get or experience

- ☐ They were **delighted with** the present I gave them.
- ☐ Were you **happy with** your exam results?

c *adjective* + **at / by / with / of**

surprised / shocked / amazed / astonished / upset AT / BY something

- ☐ Everybody was **surprised at** the news. or ... **by** the news.
☐ I hope you weren't **shocked by** what I said. or ... **at** what I said.

impressed WITH / BY somebody/something

- I'm very **impressed with** (or **by**) her English. It's very good.

fed up / bored WITH something

- ☐ I don't enjoy my job any more. I'm **fed up with** it. / I'm **bored with** it.

tired OF something

- ☐ Come on, let's go! I'm **tired of** waiting.

D sorry about / for

sorry ABOUT a situation or something that happened

- ☐ I'm **sorry about** the mess. I'll clear it up later.
- ☐ **Sorry about** last night. (= Sorry about something that happened last night)

sorry FOR / ABOUT something you did or caused

- ☐ I'm **sorry for** shouting at you yesterday. (or **sorry about** shouting)
- ☐ **Sorry for** the delay. (or **Sorry about** the delay)

You can also say 'I'm sorry I (did something)':

- ☐ I'm **sorry I shouted** at you yesterday.

feel / be sorry FOR somebody in a bad situation

- ☐ I **feel sorry for** Mark. He's had a lot of bad luck. (*not I feel sorry about Mark*)

Exercises

130.1 Complete the sentences using **nice of ...**, **kind of ...** etc.

- | | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | Tom offered to drive me to the airport. | (nice)
That was <u>nice of him</u> . |
| 2 | I needed money and Lisa gave me some. | (generous)
That her. |
| 3 | They didn't invite us to their party. | (not very nice)
That wasn't |
| 4 | Can I help you with your luggage? | (very kind)
That's |
| 5 | Kevin never says 'thank you'. | (not very polite)
That isn't |
| 6 | They've had an argument and now they refuse to speak to each other. | (a bit childish)
That's a bit |

130.2 Complete the sentences using an adjective + preposition. Choose from:

amazed angry bored careless excited impressed kind ~~nervous~~

- Are you nervous about the exam?
- Thank you for all you've done. You've been very me.
- What have I done wrong? Why are you me?
- You must be very your trip next week. It sounds really great.
- I wasn't the service in the restaurant. We had to wait ages.
- Ben isn't very happy at college. He says he's the course he's doing.
- I'd never seen so many people before. I was the crowds.
- It was you to leave the car unlocked while you were shopping.

130.3 Put in the correct preposition.

- They were delighted with the present I gave them.
- It was nice you to come and see me when I was ill.
- Why are you always so rude people? Why can't you be more polite?
- We always have the same food every day. I'm fed up it.
- We had a good holiday, but we were disappointed the hotel.
- I can't understand people who are cruel animals.
- I was surprised the way he behaved. It was completely out of character.
- I've been trying to learn Japanese, but I'm not very satisfied my progress.
- Tanya doesn't look very well. I'm worried her.
- I'm sorry yesterday. I completely forgot we'd arranged to meet.
- There's no point in feeling sorry yourself. It won't help you.
- Are you still upset what I said to you yesterday?
- Some people say Kate is unfriendly, but she's always been very nice me.
- I'm tired doing the same thing every day. I need a change.
- We interviewed ten people for the job, and we weren't impressed any of them.
- Vicky is annoyed me because I didn't agree with her.
- I'm sorry the smell in this room. I've just finished painting it.
- I was shocked what I saw. I'd never seen anything like it before.
- Jack is sorry what he did. He won't do it again.
- The hotel was incredibly expensive. I was amazed the price of a room.
- Paul made the wrong decision. It was honest him to admit it.
- You've been very generous me. You've helped me a lot.
- Our neighbours were very angry the noise we made.
- Our neighbours were furious us making so much noise.

A adjective + of

afraid / scared / frightened / terrified OF ...

- ☐ 'Are you **afraid of** spiders?' 'Yes, I'm **terrified of** them.'

fond / proud / ashamed / jealous / envious OF ...

- ☐ Why is he so **jealous of** other people?

suspicious / critical / tolerant OF ...

- ☐ They didn't trust me. They were **suspicious of** my motives.

aware / conscious OF ...

- ☐ 'Did you know he was married?' 'No, I wasn't **aware of** that.'

capable / incapable OF ...

- ☐ I'm sure you are **capable of** doing the job well.

full / short OF ...

- ☐ Amy is a very active person. She's always **full of** energy.
☐ I'm a bit **short of** money. Can you lend me some?

typical OF ...

- ☐ He's late again. It's **typical of** him to keep everybody waiting.

certain / sure OF or ABOUT ...

- ☐ I think she's arriving this evening, but I'm not **sure of** that. *or* ... not **sure about** that.

B adjective + at / to / from / in / on / with / for

good / bad / brilliant / better / hopeless etc. AT ...

- ☐ I'm not very **good at** repairing things. (*not* good in repairing things)

married / engaged TO ...

- ☐ Louise is **married to** an American. (*not* married with)

but Louise is married **with three children**. (= she is married and has three children)

similar TO ...

- ☐ Your handwriting is **similar to** mine.

different FROM or different TO ...

- ☐ The film was **different from** what I'd expected. *or* ... **different to** what I'd expected.

interested IN ...

- ☐ Are you **interested in** art?

keen ON ...

- ☐ We stayed at home. Chris wasn't **keen on** going out.

dependent ON ... (but independent OF ...)

- ☐ I don't want to be **dependent on** anybody.

crowded WITH (people etc.)

- ☐ The streets were **crowded with** tourists. (*but* ... **full of** tourists)

famous FOR ...

- ☐ The Italian city of Florence is **famous for** its art treasures.

responsible FOR ...

- ☐ Who was **responsible for** all that noise last night?

Exercises

131.1 Complete the sentences using an adjective + of. Choose from:ashamed aware capable envious proud scared ~~short~~ typical

- I'm a bit short of money. Can you lend me some?
- My children have done very well. I'm them.
- What I did was very bad. I'm myself.
- She always behaves like that. It's her.
- He wouldn't be able to run his own business. He's not it.
- I don't like going up ladders. I'm heights.
- Nobody told me she was ill. I wasn't it.
- I wish I had what Sarah has. I'm her.

131.2 Write sentences about yourself. Are you good at these things or not? You can use:

good pretty good not very good hopeless

- (repairing things) I'm not very good at repairing things.
- (telling jokes)
- (maths)
- (remembering names)
- (making decisions)

131.3 Complete the sentences using an adjective + preposition. Choose from:

afraid capable different interested proud responsible similar sure

- I think she's arriving this evening, but I'm not sure of that.
- Your camera is mine, but it isn't exactly the same.
- Don't worry. I'll look after you. There's nothing to be
- I never watch the news on TV. I'm not the news.
- The editor is the person who is what appears in a newspaper.
- Sarah is a keen gardener and is very her garden.
- I was surprised when I first met Tina. She was what I expected.
- Ben could become world champion one day. He's it.

131.4 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 There were lots of tourists in the streets. | The streets were crowded <u>with tourists</u> |
| 2 There was a lot of furniture in the room. | The room was full |
| 3 I don't like sport very much. | I'm not very keen |
| 4 We don't have enough time. | We're short |
| 5 Helen does her job very well | Helen is very good |
| 6 Steven's wife is a doctor. | Steven is married |
| 7 I don't trust Robert. | I'm suspicious |
| 8 My problem is not the same as yours. | My problem is different |

131.5 Put in the correct preposition.

- Amy is always full of energy.
- My home town is not a very interesting place. It's not famous anything.
- Kate is very fond her younger brother.
- You look bored. You don't seem interested what I'm saying.
- 'Our flight departs at 10.35.' 'Are you sure that?'
- I wanted to go out for a meal, but nobody else was keen the idea.
- These days everybody is aware the dangers of smoking.
- The station platform was crowded people waiting for the train.
- Mark has no money of his own. He's completely dependent his parents.
- We're short staff in our office right now. We need more people to do the work.

A verb + **to****talk / speak TO** somebody (**talk/speak with** is also possible)

- ☐ Who were you **talking to**?

listen TO ...

- ☐ When I'm driving, I like to **listen to** the radio. (*not* listen the radio)

apologise TO somebody (for ...)

- ☐ They **apologised to me** for their mistake. (*not* apologised me)

explain something **TO** somebody

- ☐ Can you **explain this word to me**? (*not* explain me this word)

explain / describe (to) somebody what/how/why ...

- ☐ I **explained to them** why I was worried. (*not* I explained them)

- ☐ Let me **describe to you** what I saw. (*not* Let me describe you)

B **phone** somebody, **ask** somebody etc. (*without to*)**phone / call / email / text** somebody

- ☐ I **called the airline** to cancel my flight. (*not* called to the airline)

But we say '**write** (a letter) **to** somebody'.**answer** somebody/something

- ☐ You didn't **answer my email**. (*not* answer to my email)

But we say **reply to** (an email / a letter etc.).**ask** somebody (a question)

- ☐ If there's anything you want to know, you can **ask me**. (*not* ask to me)

thank somebody (**for** ...)

- ☐ He **thanked me** for helping him. (*not* He thanked to me)

C verb + **at****look / stare / glance AT** ..., **have a look / take a look AT** ...

- ☐ Why are you **looking at** me like that?

laugh AT ...

- ☐ I look stupid with this haircut. Everybody will **laugh at** me.

aim / point (something) **AT** ..., **shoot / fire** (a gun) **AT** ...

- ☐ Don't **point** that knife **at** me. It's dangerous.

- ☐ We saw someone with a gun **shooting at** birds, but he didn't hit any.

D Some verbs can be followed by **at** or **to**, with a difference in meaning. For example:**shout AT** somebody (when you are angry or aggressive)

- ☐ He got very angry and started **shouting at** me.

shout TO somebody (so that they can hear you)

- ☐ He **shouted to** me from the other side of the street.

throw something **AT** somebody/something (to hit them)

- ☐ Somebody **threw** an egg **at** the politician.

throw something **TO** somebody (for somebody to catch)

- ☐ Lisa shouted 'Catch!' and **threw** the keys **to** me from the window.

Exercises

132.1 Which is correct?

- 1 a Can you explain this word to me? (*a is correct*)
b ~~Can you explain me this word?~~
- 2 a I got angry with Mark. Afterwards, I apologised to him.
b I got angry with Mark. Afterwards, I apologised him.
- 3 a Amy won't be able to help you. There's no point in asking to her.
b Amy won't be able to help you. There's no point in asking her.
- 4 a I need somebody to explain me what I have to do.
b I need somebody to explain to me what I have to do.
- 5 a They didn't understand the system, so I explained it to them.
b They didn't understand the system, so I explained it them.
- 6 a I like to sit on the beach and listen to the sound of the sea.
b I like to sit on the beach and listen the sound of the sea.
- 7 a I asked them to describe me exactly what happened.
b I asked them to describe to me exactly what happened.
- 8 a We'd better phone the restaurant to reserve a table.
b We'd better phone to the restaurant to reserve a table.
- 9 a It was a difficult question. I couldn't answer to it.
b It was a difficult question. I couldn't answer it.
- 10 a I explained everybody the reasons for my decision.
b I explained to everybody the reasons for my decision.
- 11 a I thanked everybody for all the help they had given me.
b I thanked to everybody for all the help they had given me.
- 12 a My friend texted to me to let me know she was going to be late.
b My friend texted me to let me know she was going to be late.

132.2 Complete the sentences. Use these verbs + the correct preposition:

explain laugh listen look point reply speak throw throw

- 1 I look stupid with this haircut. Everybody will laugh at me.
- 2 I don't understand this. Can you explain it to me?
- 3 We live in the same building, but we've never one another.
- 4 Be careful with those scissors! Don't them me!
- 5 You shouldn't directly the sun. You'll damage your eyes.
- 6 Please me! I've got something important to tell you.
- 7 Don't stones the birds!
- 8 If you don't want that sandwich, it the birds. They'll eat it.
- 9 I tried to contact Tina, but she didn't my emails.

132.3 Put in to or at.

- 1 They apologised to me for what happened.
- 2 I glanced my watch to see what time it was.
- 3 Please don't shout me! Try to calm down.
- 4 I saw Lisa and shouted her, but she didn't hear me.
- 5 Don't listen what he says. He doesn't know what he's talking about.
- 6 What's so funny? What are you laughing ?
- 7 Is it all right if I have a look your magazine?
- 8 I'm lonely. I need somebody to talk
- 9 She was so angry she threw a book the wall.
- 10 The woman sitting opposite me on the train kept staring me.
- 11 Do you have a moment? I need to speak you.

A verb + **about****talk / read / know ABOUT ...**

- ☐ We **talked about** a lot of things at the meeting.

have a discussion ABOUT something

- ☐ We had **a discussion about** what we should do.

But we say '**discuss** something' (no preposition):

- ☐ We **discussed** what we should do. (*not* discussed about)

do something/nothing **ABOUT** something = *do something/nothing to improve a situation*

- ☐ If you're worried about the problem, you should **do** something **about** it.

B verb + **for****ask** (somebody) **FOR** ...

- ☐ I sent an email to the company **asking** them **for** more information about the job.

But we say 'ask somebody **the way / the time**' etc. (no preposition):

- ☐ I **asked** somebody **the way to the station**.

apply (TO a company etc.) **FOR** a job etc.

- ☐ I think you could do this job. Why don't you **apply for** it?

wait FOR somebody, **wait FOR** something (to happen)

- ☐ Don't **wait for** me. I'll join you later.
☐ I'm not going out yet. I'm **waiting for** the rain to stop.

search (a person / a place / a bag etc.) **FOR** ...

- ☐ I've **searched** the house **for** my keys, but I still can't find them.

leave (a place) **FOR** another place

- ☐ I haven't seen her since she **left** (home) **for** work. (*not* left to work)

C **take care of, care for** and **care about****take care OF** ... = *look after, keep safe, take responsibility for*

- ☐ Don't worry about me. I can **take care of** myself.
☐ I'll **take care of** the travel arrangements. You don't need to do anything.

care FOR somebody = *take care of them, keep them safe*

- ☐ Alan is 85 and lives alone. He needs somebody to **care for** him.

I don't **care FOR** something = *I don't like it*

- ☐ I don't **care for** hot weather. (= I don't like ...)

care ABOUT ... = *think that somebody/something is important*

- ☐ He's very selfish. He doesn't **care about** other people.

care what/where/how ... etc. (*without about*)

- ☐ You can do what you like. I don't **care what** you do.

D **look for** and **look after****look FOR** ... = *search for, try to find*

- ☐ I've lost my keys. Can you help me to **look for** them?

look AFTER ... = *take care of, keep safe or in good condition*

- ☐ Alan is 85 and lives alone. He needs somebody to **look after** him. (*not* look for)
☐ You can borrow this book, but please **look after** it.

Exercises

133.1 Which is right?

- 1 We searched everywhere Joe / searched everywhere for Joe, but we couldn't find him.
(searched everywhere for Joe is correct)
- 2 I sent her an email. Now I'm waiting for her to reply / waiting her to reply.
- 3 A security guard searched my bag / searched for my bag as I entered the building.
- 4 I paid the taxi driver and asked him a receipt / asked him for a receipt.
- 5 I wanted to get to the city centre, so I stopped a man to ask the way / to ask for the way.
- 6 We discussed about the problem / discussed the problem, but we didn't reach a decision.
- 7 There are many problems, but the government does nothing for them / nothing about them.
- 8 My flight is at 9.30. What time do I need to leave the hotel to the airport / for the airport?

133.2 Put in the correct preposition. If no preposition is necessary, leave the space empty.

- 1 I'm not going out yet. I'm waiting for the rain to stop.
- 2 I've applied three universities. I hope one of them accepts me.
- 3 If you don't want the job, there's no point in applying it.
- 4 I don't want to talk what happened last night. Let's forget it.
- 5 I don't want to discuss what happened last night. Let's forget it.
- 6 We had an interesting discussion the problem, but we didn't reach a decision.
- 7 My friends are in Italy. They're in Rome now and tomorrow they leave Milan.
- 8 The roof of the house is in bad condition. We need to do something it.

133.3 Put in the correct preposition after **care**. If no preposition is necessary, leave the space empty.

- 1 He's very selfish. He doesn't care about other people.
- 2 Who's going to take care you when you are old?
- 3 She doesn't care the exam. She doesn't care whether she passes or fails.
- 4 I don't like this coat very much. I don't care the colour.
- 5 Don't worry about the shopping. I'll take care that.
- 6 He gave up his job to care his elderly father.
- 7 I want to have a good holiday. I don't care the cost.
- 8 I want to have a good holiday. I don't care how much it costs.

133.4 Complete the sentences with **look for** or **look after**. Use the correct form of **look** (**looks/looked/looking**).

- 1 I looked for my keys, but I couldn't find them anywhere.
- 2 Kate is a job. I hope she finds one soon.
- 3 Who you when you were ill?
- 4 The car park was full, so we had to somewhere else to park.
- 5 A child minder is somebody who other people's children.
- 6 I'm Lisa. I need to ask her something. Have you seen her?

133.5 Complete the sentences with these verbs (in the correct form) + a preposition:

apply ask do leave look ~~search~~ talk wait

- 1 Police are searching for a man who escaped from prison.
- 2 Sarah wasn't ready. We had to her.
- 3 I think Amy likes her job, but she doesn't it much.
- 4 Don't me money. I don't have any.
- 5 Ben is unemployed. He has several jobs, but hasn't had any luck.
- 6 If something is wrong, why don't you something it?
- 7 Helen's car is very old, but she it. It's in excellent condition.
- 8 Diane is from Boston, but now she lives in Paris. She Boston Paris when she was 19.

A**hear ABOUT** ... = *be told about something*

- ☐ Did you **hear about** the fire at the hotel?

hear OF ... = *know that somebody/something exists*

- ☐ A: Who is Tom Hart?
B: I have no idea. I've never **heard of** him. (*not heard from him*)

hear FROM ... = *be in contact with somebody*

- ☐ A: Have you **heard from** Jane recently?
B: Yes, she called me a few days ago.

B**think ABOUT** something = *consider it, concentrate your mind on it:*

- ☐ I've **thought about** what you said and I've decided to take your advice.
☐ A: Will you lend me the money?
B: I'll **think about** it. (*not think of it*)

think OF something = *produce an idea:*

- ☐ It was my idea. I **thought of** it first. (*not thought about it*)
☐ I felt embarrassed. I couldn't **think of** anything to say. (*not think about anything*)

We also use **think of** when we ask for or give an opinion:

- ☐ A: What did you **think of** the movie?
B: I didn't **think** much **of** it. (= I didn't like it much)

Sometimes the difference is very small and you can use **of** or **about**:

- ☐ When I'm alone, I often **think of** you. or ... **think about** you.

You can say **think of** or **think about** doing something (for possible future actions):

- ☐ My sister is **thinking of** going to Canada. or ... **thinking about** going ...

C**dream ABOUT** ... (when you are asleep)

- ☐ I **dreamt about** you last night.

dream OF/ABOUT being something / doing something = *imagine*

- ☐ Do you **dream of** being rich and famous? or ... **dream about** being rich ...

I **wouldn't dream OF** doing something = *I would never do it*

- ☐ 'Don't tell anyone what I said.' 'No, I **wouldn't dream of** it.'

D**complain (TO somebody) ABOUT** ... = *say that you are not satisfied*

- ☐ We **complained to** the manager of the restaurant **about** the food.

complain OF a pain, an illness etc. = *say that you have a pain etc.*

- ☐ We called the doctor because George was **complaining of** a pain in his stomach.

E**remind somebody ABOUT** ... = *tell somebody not to forget*

- ☐ It's good you **reminded me about** the meeting. I'd completely forgotten about it.

remind somebody OF ... = *cause somebody to remember*

- ☐ This house **reminds me of** the one I lived in when I was a child.
☐ Look at this photograph of Richard. Who does he **remind you of**?

Exercises

134.1 Complete the sentences using *hear* or *heard* + a preposition (*about/of/from*).

- 1 I'm surprised you haven't *heard of* her. She's quite famous.
- 2 'Did you the accident last night?' 'No, what happened?'
- 3 Sarah used to call me quite often, but I haven't her for a long time now.
- 4 'Have you William Hudson?' 'No. Who is he?'
- 5 Thanks for your email. It was good to you.
- 6 'Do you want to our trip?' 'Not now. Tell me later.'
- 7 I live in a very small town. You've probably never it.

134.2 Complete the sentences using *think about* or *think of*. Sometimes both *about* and *of* are possible. Use the correct form of *think* (*think/thinking/thought*).

- 1 I've *thought about* what you said and I've decided to take your advice.
- 2 I need time to make decisions. I like to things carefully.
- 3 You look serious. What are you ?
- 4 That's a good idea. Why didn't I that?
- 5 I don't really want to meet Tom tonight. I'll have to an excuse.
- 6 I'm buying a new car. What would you advise me to buy?
- 7 When I was offered the job, I didn't accept immediately. I went away and it for a while. In the end I decided to take the job.
- 8 A: I've just finished reading the book you lent me.
B: What did you it? Did you like it?
- 9 A: Will you be able to help me?
B: I'm not sure. I'll it.
- 10 I don't much this coffee. It's like water.
- 11 Katherine is homesick. She's always her family back home.
- 12 A: Do you think I should apply to do the course?
B: I can't any reason why not.

134.3 Put in the correct preposition.

- 1 Did you hear *about* the fire at the hotel yesterday?
- 2 I love living here. I wouldn't dream going anywhere else.
- 3 A: I had a strange dream last night.
B: Did you? What did you dream ?
- 4 I love this music. It reminds me a warm day in spring.
- 5 A: We've got no money. What are we going to do?
B: Don't worry. I'll think something.
- 6 Our neighbours complained us the noise we made.
- 7 Paul was complaining pains in his chest, so he went to the doctor.
- 8 He loves his job. He thinks it all the time, he dreams it, he talks it and I'm fed up with hearing it.

134.4 Complete the sentences using these verbs (in the correct form) + a preposition:

complain dream hear remind remind think think

- 1 It was my idea. I *thought of* it first.
- 2 Ben is never satisfied. He's always something.
- 3 I can't make a decision yet. I need time to your proposal.
- 4 He's not a well-known singer. Not many people have him.
- 5 A: You wouldn't go away without telling me, would you?
B: Of course not. I wouldn't it.
- 6 I would have forgotten my appointment if you hadn't me it.
- 7 Do you see that man over there? Does he you anybody you know?

A verb + **of****accuse / suspect** somebody **OF** ...

- ☐ Tina **accused** me **of** being selfish.
- ☐ Some students were **suspected of** cheating in the exam.

approve / disapprove OF ...

- ☐ His parents don't **approve of** what he does, but they can't stop him.

die OF or die FROM an illness etc.

- ☐ 'What did he **die of**?' 'A heart attack.'

consist OF ...

- ☐ We had an enormous meal. It **consisted of** seven courses.

B verb + **for****pay** (somebody) **FOR** ...

- ☐ We didn't have enough money to **pay for** the meal. (*not* pay the meal)
- But we say '**pay** a bill / a fine / a fee / tax / rent / a sum of money' etc. (no preposition)
- ☐ We didn't have enough money to **pay the rent**.

thank / forgive somebody **FOR** ...

- ☐ I'll never **forgive** them **for** what they did.

apologise (TO somebody) FOR ...

- ☐ When I realised I was wrong, I **apologised (to them) for** my mistake.

blame somebody/something **FOR** ... , somebody is **to blame FOR** ...

- ☐ Everybody **blamed** me **for** the accident.
- ☐ Everybody said that I was **to blame for** the accident.

blame (a problem etc.) **ON** ...

- ☐ It wasn't my fault. Don't **blame** it **on** me.

C verb + **from****suffer FROM** an illness etc.

- ☐ There's been an increase in the number of people **suffering from** heart disease.

protect somebody/something **FROM** ...

- ☐ Sun cream **protects** the skin **from** the sun.

D verb + **on****depend ON** ... , **rely ON** ...

- ☐ I don't know what time we'll arrive. It **depends on** the traffic.
 - ☐ You can **rely on** Anna. She always keeps her promises.
- You can use **depend + when/where/how** etc. with or without **on**:
- ☐ 'Are you going to buy it?' 'It **depends how much** it is.' (*or* 'It depends **on** how much ...')

live ON money/food

- ☐ Michael's salary is very low. It isn't enough to **live on**.

congratulate / compliment somebody **ON** ...

- ☐ I **congratulated** her **on** doing so well in her exams.
- ☐ The meal was really good. I **complimented** Mark **on** his cooking skills.

Exercises

135.1 Put in the correct preposition. If no preposition is necessary, leave the space empty.

- 1 Some students were suspected of cheating in the exam.
- 2 Are you going to apologise what you did?
- 3 The apartment consists three rooms, a kitchen and bathroom.
- 4 I was accused lying, but I was telling the truth.
- 5 We finished our meal, paid the bill, and left the restaurant.
- 6 The accident was my fault, so I had to pay the repairs.
- 7 Some people are dying hunger, while others eat too much.
- 8 I called Helen to thank her the present she sent me.
- 9 The government is popular. Most people approve its policies.
- 10 Do you blame the government our economic problems?
- 11 When something goes wrong, you always blame it other people.
- 12 Forgive me interrupting, but I'd like to ask you something.

135.2 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

- 1 Sue said that I was selfish.
Sue accused me of being selfish
- 2 The misunderstanding was my fault, so I apologised.
I apologised
- 3 Jane won the tournament, so I congratulated her.
I congratulated
- 4 He has enemies, and he has a bodyguard to protect him.
He has a bodyguard to protect
- 5 Sandra eats only bread and eggs.
Sandra lives
- 6 You can't say that the bad weather is my fault.
You can't blame
- 7 The police thought my friend had stolen a car.
The police suspected

135.3 Complete the sentences using these verbs (in the correct form) + a preposition:

accuse apologise approve congratulate depend live pay suffer

- 1 His parents don't approve of what he does, but they can't stop him.
- 2 When you went to the theatre with Paul, who the tickets?
- 3 It's not pleasant when you are something you didn't do.
- 4 We hope to go to the beach tomorrow, but it the weather.
- 5 Things are cheap there. You can very little money.
- 6 You were rude to Lisa. I think you should her.
- 7 Alex back pain. He spends too much time working at his desk.
- 8 I called Jack to him passing his driving test.

135.4 Put in the correct preposition. If no preposition is necessary, leave the space empty.

- 1 I'll never forgive them for what they did.
- 2 Vaccinations may protect you a number of diseases.
- 3 You know you can always rely me if you need any help.
- 4 Sophie will have to borrow money to pay her college fees.
- 5 She's often unwell. She suffers very bad headaches.
- 6 I don't know whether I'll go out tonight. It depends how I feel.
- 7 Anna doesn't have a job. She depends her parents for money.
- 8 My usual breakfast consists fruit, cereal and coffee.
- 9 I complimented her her English. It was really good.

A verb + **in****believe IN** ... = *believe that something exists, believe that it's good to do something*☐ Do you **believe in** God? (= do you believe that God exists?)☐ I **believe in** saying what I think. (= I believe it is right to say what I think)but '**believe** something' (= believe that it is true), '**believe** somebody' (= believe what they say):☐ The story can't be true. I don't **believe it**. (*not believe in it*)**specialise IN** ...☐ Helen is a lawyer. She **specialises in** company law.**succeed IN** ...☐ I hope you **succeed in** finding the job you want.**B** verb + **into****break INTO** ...☐ Our house was **broken into** a few days ago, but nothing was stolen.**crash / drive / bump / run INTO** ...☐ He lost control of the car and **crashed into** a wall.**divide / cut / split** something **INTO** two or more parts☐ The book is **divided into** three parts.**translate** a book etc. **FROM** one language **INTO** another☐ She's a famous writer. Her books have been **translated into** many languages.**C** verb + **with****collide WITH** ...☐ There was an accident this morning. A bus **collided with** a car.**fill** something **WITH** ... (*but full of* – see Unit 131A)☐ Take this saucepan and **fill it with** water.**provide / supply** somebody **WITH** ...☐ The school **provides** all its students **with** books.**D** verb + **to****happen TO** ...☐ What **happened to** that gold watch you used to have? (= where is it now?)**invite** somebody **TO** a party / a wedding etc.☐ They only **invited** a few people **to** their wedding.**prefer** one thing **TO** another☐ I **prefer** tea **to** coffee.**E** verb + **on****concentrate ON** ...☐ I tried to **concentrate on** my work, but I kept thinking about other things.**insist ON** ...☐ I wanted to go alone, but some friends of mine **insisted on** coming with me.**spend** (money) **ON** ...☐ How much do you **spend on** food each week?

Exercises

136.1 Complete the sentences using these verbs (in the correct form) + a preposition:believe break concentrate divide drive fill happen ~~insist~~ invite succeed

- I wanted to go alone, but my friends insisted on coming with me.
- I haven't seen Mike for ages. I wonder what has him.
- It's a very large house. It's four apartments.
- We've been the party, but unfortunately we can't go.
- I don't ghosts. I think people imagine that they see them.
- Steve gave me an empty bucket and told me to it water.
- A burglar is someone who a house to steal things.
- Don't try and do two things together. one thing at a time.
- It wasn't easy, but in the end we finding a solution to the problem.
- The car in front of me stopped suddenly. Unfortunately I couldn't stop in time and the back of it.

136.2 Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first.

- There was a collision between a bus and a car.
A bus collided with a car
- I don't mind big cities, but I prefer small towns.
I prefer
- I got all the information I needed from the company.
The company provided me
- This morning I bought a pair of shoes, which cost eighty pounds.
This morning I spent
- There are ten districts in the city.
The city is divided

136.3 Put in the correct preposition. If the sentence is already complete, leave the space empty.

- The school provides all its students with books.
- A strange thing happened me a few days ago.
- Mark decided to give up sport to concentrate his studies.
- Money should be used well. I don't believe wasting it.
- My present job isn't wonderful, but I prefer it what I did before.
- I hope you succeed getting what you want.
- Ben was injured playing football when he collided another player.
- There was an awful noise as the car crashed a tree.
- Patrick is a photographer. He specialises sports photography.
- Joe doesn't spend much money clothes.
- I was amazed when I heard the news. I couldn't believe it.
- Somebody broke my car and stole my bag.
- I was quite cold, but Tom insisted having the window open.
- The teacher decided to split the class four groups.
- I filled the tank, but unfortunately I filled it the wrong kind of fuel.
- Some things are difficult to translate one language another.

136.4 Use your own ideas to complete these sentences. Use a preposition.

- I wanted to go out alone, but my friend insisted on coming with me
- I spend a lot of money
- I saw an accident. A car crashed
- Chris prefers basketball
- The restaurant we went to specialises
- Shakespeare's plays have been translated